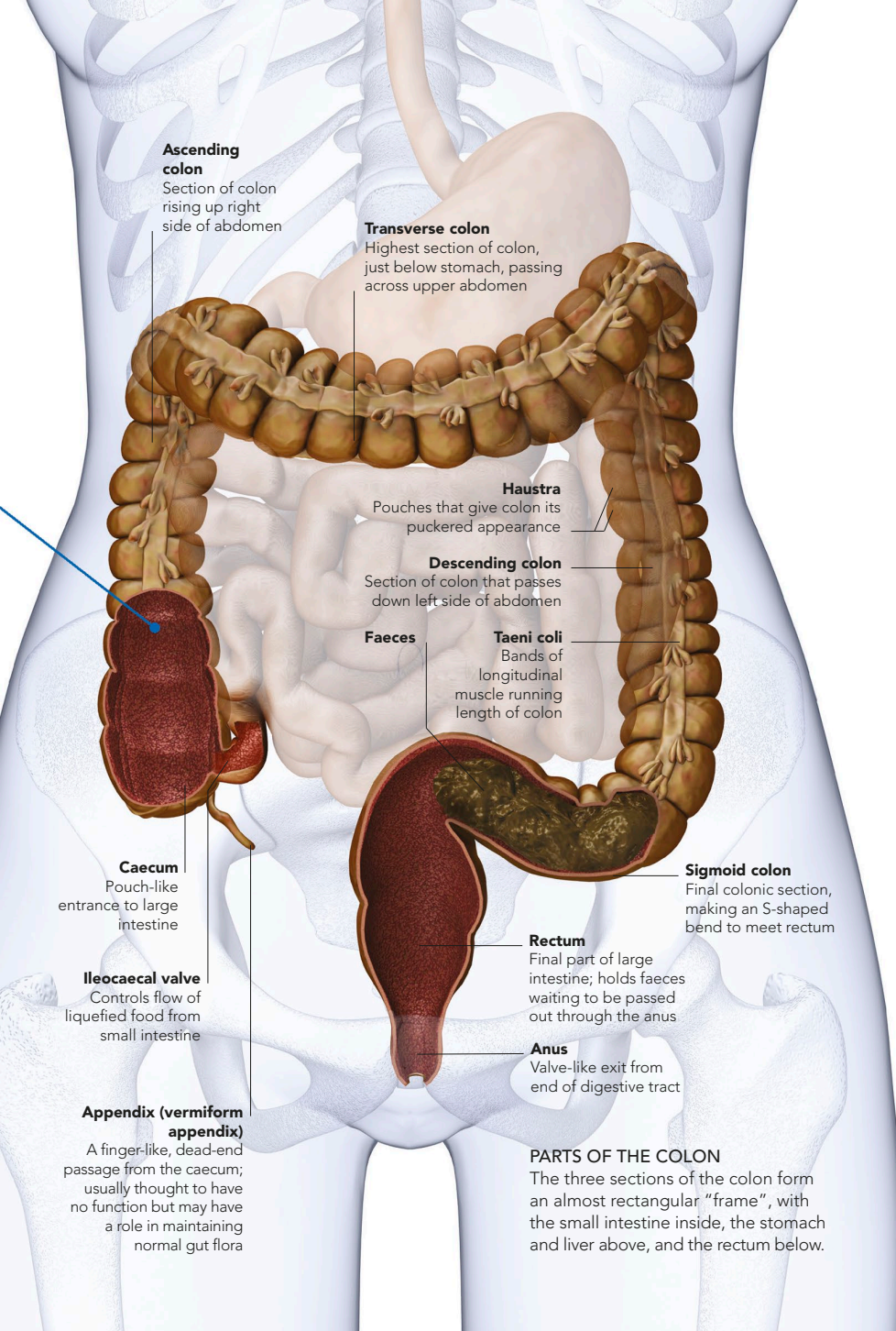


**Ascending colon**

Section of colon rising up right side of abdomen

Transverse colon

Highest section of colon, just below stomach, passing across upper abdomen

Haustra

Pouches that give colon its puckered appearance

Descending colon

Section of colon that passes down left side of abdomen

Faeces**Taeni coli**

Bands of longitudinal muscle running length of colon

Caecum

Pouch-like entrance to large intestine

Ileocaecal valve

Controls flow of liquefied food from small intestine

Appendix (vermiform appendix)

A finger-like, dead-end passage from the caecum; usually thought to have no function but may have a role in maintaining normal gut flora

Sigmoid colon

Final colonic section, making an S-shaped bend to meet rectum

Rectum

Final part of large intestine; holds faeces waiting to be passed out through the anus

Anus

Valve-like exit from end of digestive tract

PARTS OF THE COLON

The three sections of the colon form an almost rectangular "frame", with the small intestine inside, the stomach and liver above, and the rectum below.